Steven Mesquiti, M.A.

Department of Psychology | Princeton University | sm9518@princeton.edu

Education

Princeton University (2024–Present)
Ph.D. in Psychology | Advisor: Dr. Erik Nook

Princeton University (2024–2026)
M.A. in Psychology | Advisor: Dr. Erik Nook

Texas State University (2019–2022)
M.A. in Psychological Research | Advisor: Dr. Randall Osborne

Southwestern University (2015–2019)
B.A. in Psychology (Minor: Spanish)

Funding & Fellowships

- **2026-27** — Princeton Precision Health Graduate Fellowship ($24,100)
- **2026** — Princeton University Data Driven Social Science Graduate Fellowship ($1,200)
- **2025** — Princeton University Data Driven Social Science Graduate Fellowship ($1,200)
- **2025** — Princeton University Data Driven Social Science: Data-Driven Approaches to Building Equitable Language-Based Mental Health Assessments ($4,283)
- **2025** — New Jersey Health Foundation: Investigating Racial Equity of Psycholinguistic Measures of Mental Health (PI: Erik C. Nook; $34,867; #PC 42-25)
- **2024–25** — Princeton University William G. Bowen Merit Fellowship
- **2022** — Northwestern University Kellogg School of Management Behavioral Research Fellowship (Finalist [Declined]; $35,000)
- **2021** — Masters in Psychological Research Graduate Competitive Scholarship
- **2020–21** — Texas State University Graduate College of Liberal Arts Scholarship
- **2020** — Texas State University Thesis Research Support Fellowship ($1,070)
- **2019** — Texas State University Graduate College of Education Scholarship
- **2015** — Southwestern University Mood Scholar

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Publications

- **Mesquiti, S.** & Nook, E.C. (2026). Large Language Models in Mental Health Treatment and Research. *Annual Reviews BioMedical Data Science*. DOI
- **Mesquiti, S.**, Cosme, D., Nook, E.C., Falk E.B., Burns S. (2026). Predicting Psychological and Subjective Well-being through Language-based Assessments of Well-being. *Communications Psychology*. DOI
- Muzekari, B., Cooper, N., Resnick, A., Paul, A. M., Torres-Grillo, O. E., Andrews, M. E., Mattan, B., Scholz, C., Johnson, D., Carreras-Tartak, J., Cakar, M. E., Hao, S., Zhou, E., Beard, E., **Mesquiti, S.**, Sayed, F., Fichman, M. A., Lydon-Staley, D. M., Barnett, I. J., … Falk, E. B. (2025). Naturalistic Tobacco Retail Exposure and Smoking Outcomes in Adults Who Smoke Cigarettes Daily. *JAMA Network Open*. DOI
- **Mesquiti, S.**, Seraj, S., Weyland, A. H., Ashokkumar, A., Boyd, R. L., Mihalcea, R., & Pennebaker, J. W. (2025). Analysis of social media language reveals the psychological interaction of three successive upheavals. *Scientific Reports*, 15(1), 5740. DOI
- Kang, Y., **Mesquiti, S.**, Baik, E.S., & Falk, E. B. (2024). Empathy and Helping: The Role of Affect in Response to Others' Suffering. *Scientific Reports*, 15, 3256. DOI
- **Mesquiti, S.**, Seraj, S. (2023). The Psychological Impacts of the COVID-19 Pandemic on Business Leadership. *PLOS One*. DOI

Manuscripts Under Review

- **Mesquiti, S.**, Stade, E. C., Hull, T. D., & Nook, E. C. (Under Revision). The Meaning of "I": Semantic Self-Representation Tracks Internalizing Symptoms Within and Across Persons in Psychotherapy. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*. DOI
- Sahi, R. S., **Mesquiti, S.**, Hull, T. D., Vine, V., & Nook, E. C. (Under Revision). Affect labeling is linked with better mental health in psychotherapeutic conversations. *Nature Mental Health*.
- **Mesquiti, S.**, Carey, R. M., Daw, N., & Nook, E. C. (Submitted). Investigating Racial Equity of Psycholinguistic Measures of Mental Health. DOI

Works in Progress

- Huang, E., Whiting, C., **Mesquiti, S.**, Baran, S. S., & Nook, E. C. (In Preparation). Linguistic markers of self-representation reflect daily emotional experiences in an expressive writing study.
- Kang, Y., **Mesquiti, S.** & Falk, E. B. (in prep). The Effect of Compassion Training on Emotional Support Giving.

Invited Talks

- **2026** — Investigating Racial Sensitivity in Language-Based Assessments of Mental Health. Social Psychology Seminar, Princeton University, Princeton, NJ.
- **2026** — Investigating Racial Sensitivity in Language-Based Assessments of Mental Health. DDSS Connect: Interdisciplinary Exchange.
- **2025** — Predicting Mental Health Outcomes with the Latent Meaning of "I" in a Large Therapy Dataset. DDSS Connect: Interdisciplinary Exchange.
- **2025** — Tracking Shifts in the Latent Meaning of "I" and Its Connection to Mental Health Outcomes in a Large Therapy Dataset. Social Psychology Seminar, Princeton University, Princeton, NJ.
- **2022** — Within-and between-person effects of autonomous motivation on goal pursuit. Duckworth Lab.
- **2021** — The whole truth and nothing but the truth: an analysis of the variability of prosocial lying in the Netherlands and the United States. Texas State University Psychology Department Brown Bag.
- **2021** — The truth about prosocial lying: Cross-cultural differences in prosocial lying. Southwestern Psychological Association (Virtual).

Conference Presentations

- Huang, E., Whiting, C., **Mesquiti, S.**, Baran, S. S., & Nook, E. C. (2027). Linguistic markers of self-representation reflect emotional experiences in expressive writing. Poster presented at the annual meeting for the Society for Personality and Social Psychology. Phila. PA.
- **Mesquiti, S.**, Carey, R. M., Daw, N., & Nook, E. C. (2026). Investigating Racial Equity of Psycholinguistic Measures of Mental Health. Oral presentation at the annual meeting of the Society for Research in Psychopathology. Columbus, OH.
- Huang, E., Whiting, C., **Mesquiti, S.**, Baran, S. S., & Nook, E. C. (2026). Linguistic markers of self-representation reflect emotional experiences in expressive writing. Poster presentation at the annual meeting of the Society for Research in Psychopathology. Columbus, OH.
- **Mesquiti, S.**, Stade E. C., Hull, T.D., Nook, E. C. (2026). Tracking shifts in the latent meaning of "I" and its connection to mental health outcomes in a large therapy dataset. Poster presentation at the annual meeting of the Society for Affective Science. Pittsburgh, PA.
- **Mesquiti, S.**, Nook, E. (2025, March). Investigating Racial Sensitivity in Language-Based Assessments of Mental Health. Poster presented at the annual meeting for the Society for Affective Science.
- **Mesquiti, S.**, Cosme, D., Nook, E., Falk E., Burns S. (2025, February). Predicting Well-being with Language-based Assessments. Poster presented at the annual meeting for the Society for Personality and Social Psychology.
- **Mesquiti, S.**, Burns S., Cosme, D., Falk E. (2024, February). Enhancing Psychological Well-being Prediction Through Natural Language Analysis. Poster presented at the annual

meeting for the Society for Personality and Social Psychology.

- **Mesquiti, S.**, Mobasser, A., Falk, E., Pfeifer, J. H., & Cosme, D (2023, February). Within- and between-person effects of autonomous motivation on goal pursuit. Poster submitted to the annual meeting for the Society for Personality and Social Psychology.
- Spehar, A., Muzekari, B., Butler, T. B., **Mesquiti, S.**, Cosme, D., Falk, E. (2022, August). Exploring the Relationships between Linguistic Arousal, Emotional Tone, and Sharing Behaviors. Poster presented at the annual University of Pennsylvania MindCORE student show case. Philadelphia, Pa. Github
- Andrews, M. E., Cooper, N., Paul, A., Johnson, D., Muzekari, B., **Mesquiti, S.C.**, Torres, O., Resnick, A., Scholz, C., Mattan, B., Barnet, I., Henriksen, L., Strasser, A., & Falk, E. B. (2023, May). Compounding effect of microaggressions and exposure to tobacco advertising on stress and smoking. Annual conference of the International Communication Association, Toronto, Ontario, Canada.
- Santana, C., **Mesquiti, S.C.**, Carreras-Tartak, J., Kang, Y., Falk, E. (2022, August). Relating Collective and Self-Focus Language in Social Support with Self-Reported Depression. Poster presented at the annual University of Pennsylvania MindCORE student show case. Philadelphia, Pa.
- Woolfolk, Z., Cosme, D., Butler, T., Carreras-Tartak, J., **Mesquiti, S.C.**, Kang, Y., Falk, E. (2022, August). Racial Homophily in Emotion Sharing Network. Poster presented at the annual University of Pennsylvania MindCORE student show case. Philadelphia, Pa.
- **Mesquiti, S.C.** (2022, April). Exploring Cognitive Language of CEOs during the COVID-19 Pandemic Over Time and its Connection to Decision Processing. Poster presented at the annual Texas State University Psychology Department Showcase. San Marcos, Tx.
- **Mesquiti, S.C.**, Tsai, J. L., Marion, J., Olivarez, O., Blackburn, K., Durland, M. (2022, February). The linguistic lifespan of a CEO: Exploring the way cognitive language unfolds over time and its connection to decision processing. Poster presented at the annual meeting for the Society for Personality and Social Psychology.
- Haskard-Zolnierek, K., **Mesquiti, S.C.**, & Snyder, M. (2022, February). Associations between patient satisfaction and physician and nurse word use. Poster presented at the annual meeting for the Society for Personality and Social Psychology (virtual).
- **Mesquiti, S.C.**, Kok, R., Clegg, J. M., Warnell, K. R. (2021, April). The truth behind prosocial lies: A linguistic analysis of lying to be polite. Poster presented at the annual Texas State University Psychology Department Showcase. San Marcos, Tx.
- **Mesquiti, S.C.**, Domer, K., Warnell, K. R., Clegg, J. M. (2021, February). More than a disappointing gift: Examining variability in when and how we prosocially lie. Poster presented at the annual meeting for the Society for Personality and Social Psychology (virtual).
- Domer, K., **Mesquiti, S.C.**, Warnell, K. R., Clegg, J. M. (2021, February). More than a social norm: Examining who we lie to and what we lie about. Poster presented at the annual meeting for the Society for Personality and Social Psychology (virtual).
- **Mesquiti, S.C.** (2019, April). Internship at the Central Texas Treatment Center. Poster presented at Southwestern University Creative Works Symposium, Georgetown, Tx.

Mentorship

- **Song Ting Tang** — Thesis Student, Princeton University (2025–Present)
- **Emi Yun** — Thesis Student, Princeton University (2024–2026)
- **Arden Spehar** — Summer MindCORE REU Student, University of Pennsylvania (2022)
- **Carlos Santana** — Summer MindCORE REU Student, University of Pennsylvania (2022)

Skills

Natural Language Processing & Computational Linguistics
Transformer-based language models, semantic projection & embedding-based measurement, topic modeling (LDA), dictionary-based methods, language-based assessments.

Machine Learning & Statistical Methods
Supervised learning & fine-tuning, ridge regression, mixed-effects/multilevel modeling, moderation & mediation analysis.

Programming & Computing
R (proficient), Python (moderate), SQL, Bash, reproducible research (Quarto)

Research Methods
Longitudinal & clinical text data, large-scale social media data, within- and between-person designs, mixed-method design, open science practices.

Peer Review

- Behavior Research Methods
- Clinical Psychological Science
- Journal of Medical Internet Research
- Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin
- Scientific Reports
- Harvard Review of Psychiatry

References

- **Erik Nook** — Assistant Professor of Psychology, Princeton University | enook@princeton.edu
- **James Pennebaker** — Professor Emeritus of Psychology, The University of Texas at Austin | pennebaker@utexas.edu
- **Emily Falk** — Professor of Communication, Psychology, Marketing, and OID, Vice Dean of the Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania | efalk@falklab.org